BUSINESS INTELLIGENCE PORTFOLIO REPORT

India Connectivity Intelligence 2026

Market evidence, Jio's operating position, and conditional satellite use cases

How can Jio strengthen customer growth and retention while satellite internet creates potential connectivity options for underserved areas of India?

EVIDENCE CUT-OFF	PRIMARY SOURCES	AUTHOR
14 October 2026	**TRAI, DoT, PIB, RIL**	**Gourav Pawar**
Latest official releases reviewed	No private customer data used	BBA-BIA, LNCT Bhopal

The report separates regulator observations, company-reported metrics, calculated comparisons, and strategic hypotheses. It does not present customer research or model results that were not observed.

Executive summary

India's connectivity market continued to expand in the latest official quarterly series. Rural subscription density remains materially lower than urban density, while Jio reports scale across mobile, 5G, and fixed broadband. Satellite connectivity is a conditional option; regulatory milestones alone do not establish retail readiness.

INTERNET SUBSCRIPTIONS	BROADBAND SUBSCRIPTIONS
1.96%	**2.03%**
March-June change: +21.38M	March-June change: +21.62M
RURAL DENSITY, JUNE	JIO CUSTOMER BASE, Q1 FY27
49.07 / 100	**533.3M**
vs 129.03 urban; subscriptions, not people	Company-reported

What the evidence supports

The market is expanding and Jio reports a large operating base. TRAI's June subscription-density figures point to a rural-urban gap, while August data show fixed wireless already serving rural locations. These observations support targeted measurement; they do not prove dissatisfaction, willingness to switch, demand for satellite, or a cause of growth.

Recommended direction

For Jio, measure wired broadband and AirFiber quality and retention separately by service type and location. For Starlink, verify orderability, India price, footprint, installation, capacity, and support before estimating a market. Customer recommendations need primary research.

Source context: TRAI market data [S1-S3]; Jio company-reported data [S4].

1. Question, scope, and evidence

This report asks how Jio can strengthen growth and retention while satellite internet creates potential connectivity options for underserved areas. It covers official market measures, Jio's latest published operating metrics, the August connectivity mix, and Starlink's recorded regulatory milestones. It is not a completed customer analytics study.

Evidence	Use in this report	Boundary
TRAI observations	Market totals, density, broadband mix	Subscriptions can include multiple accounts and M2M; period and definition matter.
RIL company data	Jio base, True5G, ARPU, churn, fixed broadband	Company definitions are not assumed identical to TRAI's.
Derived values	Growth, density gap, FWA share	Arithmetic from cited values; formulas are in analysis files.
Hypotheses	Potential terrestrial/satellite use cases	Not observed customer demand; needs local evidence.

Period discipline

The annual TRAI series ends in March 2026; the latest quarterly performance report covers April-June 2026 and was published on 12 October; its monthly subscription release covers August 2026. RIL's latest located Jio presentation covers the quarter ended 30 June. Monthly and quarterly values remain separate.

No survey responses, customer records, synthetic records, or third-party estimates were used.

2. Market momentum

TRAI's quarterly performance series shows continued growth between March and June 2026. The calculations use the same series and end-of-quarter dates.

March-June 2026 growth in TRAI subscription counts

Calculated from reported quarter-end counts



Internet subscriptions increased from 1,092.79 million to 1,114.17 million, a gain of 21.38 million (1.96%). Broadband subscriptions increased from 1,065.88 million to 1,087.50 million, a gain of 21.62 million (2.03%). [S1, S2]

TRAI's FY2025-26 annual report recorded broadband subscription growth of 12.90%. This describes market expansion; it does not explain the drivers or show that service quality improved everywhere. [S2]

Wireless-service ARPU was INR 180.73 per month as a 2025-26 financial-year average and INR 187.12 for the April-June 2026 quarter. These periods differ, and neither value is a customer plan price. [S1, S2]

Interpretation

Growth creates room for acquisition, but retention and monetisation depend on local quality, usage, affordability, and availability. Those customer-level drivers are absent from public aggregates.

3. Access is uneven across urban and rural India

At June 2026, TRAI reported 129.03 urban and 49.07 rural internet subscriptions per 100 population. The difference is 79.96; urban density is approximately 2.63 times rural density. [S1]

Internet subscriptions per 100 population, June 2026

Subscription density, not unique-person adoption



These values can exceed 100 because a person or organisation may hold multiple subscriptions. The metric is useful as a population-normalised indicator, but it is not the share of people online or a count of people without service.

TRAI's August release recorded 13.45 million 5G fixed-wireless-access subscriptions: 6.98 million rural and 6.47 million urban. Rural subscriptions accounted for 51.90% of that base. This shows fixed wireless is already one option in some rural locations; it does not establish quality or demand for satellite. [S3]

Use the signal carefully

Prioritise local checks of serviceability, uptime, actual speed, affordability, and customer experience. National subscription density is not a district-level coverage map.

4. Jio's published operating position

For Q1 FY2026-27, the quarter ended 30 June 2026, Reliance Industries reported the following Jio operating measures. [S4]

Metric	Q1 FY27 value	Reading note
Total customer base	533.3 million	Company-reported; not assumed equivalent to TRAI count.
Net customer additions	8.9 million	Quarterly additions; not a retention rate.
True5G users	About 285 million	Company-reported technology adoption measure.
ARPU	INR 215.6 per month	Company-defined average revenue per user.
Monthly churn	1.6%	Company-reported; retain its definition and denominator.
Fixed-broadband base	28.6 million	Company-reported fixed-broadband operating base.
JioAirFiber home connections	14.0 million	Company-reported home connections.

The August TRAI release separately lists 538.03 million Jio broadband subscriptions and a 48.86% provider share. That total includes wired and wireless broadband, including mobile. TRAI reports 14.81 million Jio fixed-wired subscriptions in the same release. These values answer different questions from RIL's June report; do not call 538.03 million home broadband customers. [S3]

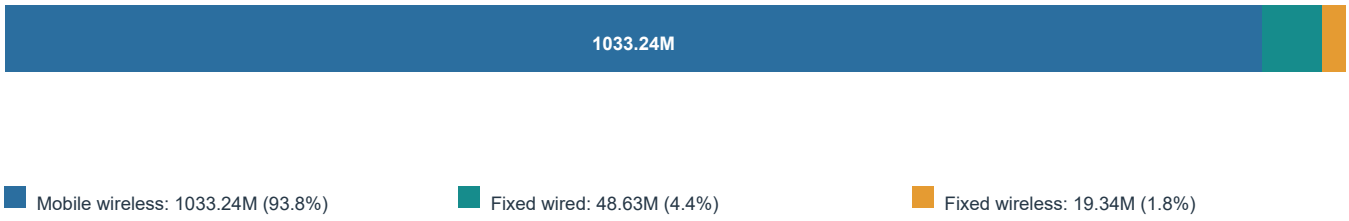
Management question

Given Jio's fixed-broadband scale, analyse service quality and retention separately for wired broadband and AirFiber, by service area, installation cohort, and customer type. Public data does not show which cohort has a problem.

5. The August broadband mix

TRAI's August monthly series reports 1,101.21 million broadband subscriptions with M2M and 1,010.28 million without M2M. The components below reconcile to the with-M2M total. Do not blend this series into March-June quarterly growth without reconciling scope. [S3]

August 2026 broadband subscriptions with M2M



Source: TRAI. Fixed wireless includes 5G FWA and UBR.

Within 19.34 million fixed-wireless subscriptions, TRAI lists 13.45 million as 5G FWA. The chart compares its rural and urban totals. [S3]

5G FWA subscriptions by area, August 2026

TRAI monthly subscription series



Mobile remains the largest category in the reported total. Fixed wireless is smaller but includes millions of rural subscriptions. Satellite should be compared against alternatives at a specific location; the national mix alone cannot determine the best technology.

6. Starlink: authorisation is not market availability

A Government of India backgrounder reports two India-specific milestones for Starlink Satellite Communications Pvt. Ltd. [S6]

Date	Milestone	What it establishes
6 June 2025	DoT Unified License authorising GMPCS, Commercial VSAT, and ISP-A services nationwide.	Authorisation scope.
8 July 2025	IN-SPACe approval for Gen1 constellation capacity in India for five years.	Capacity approval for the stated term.

What is still needed for a market claim

Authorisation is not proof of retail orderability, commercial launch, service footprint, India pricing, terminal cost, installation, service quality, support, subscribers, or market share. The official availability map loaded, but its interactive country status could not be read reliably here. These facts remain unverified in this report. [S6, S7]

Strategic hypothesis

Satellite may fit remote households, business sites, public-service locations, or network backhaul where terrestrial options are unavailable or fail a defined service threshold. This is a hypothesis, not a measured customer segment. Compare total cost, availability, latency, reliability, capacity, installation, and support against fibre, fixed wireless, and mobile at the target location.

No India-specific Starlink price or market-share estimate is included.

7. Prioritised recommendations

Priority	Action	Evidence and confidence
1 - Jio	Measure wired broadband and AirFiber separately: installation time, first-month failures, uptime, complaints, upgrades, and cancellations by service area and customer type.	The reported 28.6M fixed base and 14.0M AirFiber base support measurement; specific pain points are unverified. [S4]
2 - Jio	Combine serviceability and quality data with TRAI area patterns to prioritise local expansion; test fibre and FWA economics by location.	Urban-rural density differs; rural 5G FWA exists. Local cost and coverage data are needed. [S1, S3]
3 - Starlink	Verify orderability, footprint, terminal and installation cost, price, capacity, performance, support, and regulatory conditions before estimating demand.	Authorisation is documented; current retail availability was not verified here. [S6, S7]
4 - Research	Run an opt-in exploratory survey and interviews across locations and connectivity types. Publish recruitment method and actual sample size.	No customer-level evidence was available. A convenience sample is not representative.
5 - Analytics	Build a Power BI report with separate market, customer, retention, opportunity, and definitions pages; show source and period.	Measures have different reporting grains. No .pbix is included in this release. [S1-S4]

Decision rule

Do not choose a technology or customer offer from national subscription totals alone. Compare target-location serviceability, total installed and recurring costs, speed, latency, uptime, installation lead time, and support.

8. Next analytics phase

Customer analytics can begin when primary data is available and the sample is documented.

Data layer	Minimum fields	Analysis enabled
Public market	Source, date, period, value, unit, definition, geography.	Trends, growth, provider mix, density.
Survey	Consent, coarse geography, access type, spend band, reliability, satisfaction, switching, hypothetical offer reaction.	Exploratory profiles and stated price acceptance; report sample limits.
Customer records	Lawful anonymised events, tenure, spend, service, complaints, cancellation and outcome window.	Churn/retention with baseline, time split, leakage checks, validation.
Service readiness	Availability, installation cost/time, performance, support, capacity, approval status.	Technology comparison for named locations.

Survey safeguards

Make participation voluntary, explain intended use, avoid names and phone numbers, and publish recruitment method and response count. A 100-200 response target can be exploratory, not representative. Use neutral wording for price and switching questions.

Limitations and conclusion

This report is descriptive. It does not explain why subscriptions changed, establish causality, measure satisfaction, estimate willingness to pay, forecast Starlink adoption, or predict churn. Subscription counts can include multiple accounts and M2M. June quarterly and August monthly series differ in scope; company measures use company definitions. The analysis lacks household-level coverage, quality, price, and installation data, and the Starlink map status was unreadable.

India's market scale, lower rural subscription density, Jio's fixed-broadband scale, and rural 5G FWA presence justify targeted work. They do not prove that a customer group wants satellite or that it is the best option. The next step is to combine location-level service data with a carefully sampled customer study and compare options on total cost and performance.

Included in this release: report, source register, public-data extract, Python calculations, example SQL, dashboard plan, and LinkedIn draft. No survey, customer model, Power BI file, GitHub push, or LinkedIn publication is included.

Sources

Official primary sources retrieved on 14 October 2026. Full definitions and scope notes appear in references/sources.md.

[S1] TRAI, The Indian Telecom Services Performance Indicators, April-June 2026 (published 12 October 2026).

[S2] TRAI, The Indian Telecom Services Yearly Performance Indicators 2025-26 (published 5 October 2026).

[S3] TRAI, Telecom Subscription Data at the end of August 2026 (published 28 September 2026).

[S4] Reliance Industries, Q1 FY2026-27 Financial Results Presentation (published 17 July 2026).

[S5] Department of Telecommunications, National Broadband Mission 2.0.

[S6] PIB, Leap Beyond: Elevating India's Space Saga (Starlink India authorisation milestones).

[S7] Starlink, Availability Map (country status could not be read reliably in this review).

Growth formula: (current value - prior value) / prior value x 100. Urban-rural gap: urban subscriptions per 100 population minus rural subscriptions per 100. Rural FWA share: rural 5G FWA subscriptions divided by all 5G FWA subscriptions. Derived metrics are rounded to two decimals.